

I'm going to give you **25**, not just 20.

And I'll phrase the answers in a way you can actually speak during the judging.

Q1. What exactly is your problem statement?

Answer:

Cryptocurrency fraud investigations become difficult when stolen funds move through multiple wallets, split across addresses, interact with smart contracts or cross blockchain networks. Our solution automates the repetitive parts of investigation by tracing fund flows, identifying suspicious patterns, correlating wallets and entities, generating risk signals and producing evidence-backed investigative reports.

Q2. How is this different from Etherscan or Blockscout?

Answer:

Etherscan and Blockscout are primarily blockchain explorers. They tell us what transactions happened. Our platform converts those transactions into investigative intelligence. We trace funds across multiple hops, detect behavioral patterns, build transaction graphs, generate risk signals, correlate findings with evidence and provide investigator recommendations and reports.

This distinction is explicitly central to your README.

Q3. Why do you need AI at all?

Answer:

We don't use AI for everything. Deterministic rules and graph analytics handle factual transaction analysis. ML identifies statistical and anomalous behavior. AI is used mainly to interpret structured evidence, summarize investigation findings and generate recommendations. This separation makes the system more explainable and reduces hallucination risk.

Q4. Why three LLMs?

Answer:

We separate the responsibilities. Qwen acts as the investigation analyst, Mistral reviews whether the generated conclusions are actually supported by evidence, and Llama acts as the investigator copilot for explanations and recommendations. This prevents a single model from generating and validating its own conclusion.

Q5. What if the LLM hallucinates?

Answer:

The LLM does not directly determine the final truth. Its output is converted into claims that are correlated against transaction and evidence IDs. If a claim cannot be supported by our structured evidence, it is marked unsupported or uncertain. We also distinguish facts, inferences, recommendations and uncertainties.

This is one of your best answers because your architecture explicitly includes evidence correlation.

Q6. Can your system say that someone committed fraud?

Answer:

No. The system generates an explainable investigation-risk indicator. It does not produce a criminal verdict. Final interpretation and legal decisions remain with the human investigator.

Say this confidently.

Q7. Why use XGBoost?

Answer:

XGBoost is useful for structured tabular features such as transaction frequency, transaction amounts, hop counts and behavioral indicators. It can provide a useful supervised risk signal while remaining relatively efficient for an MVP.

Q8. Why Isolation Forest?

Answer:

Fraud patterns may not always have sufficient labelled examples. Isolation Forest allows us to identify unusual transaction behavior without requiring every transaction to have a fraud label. We use that as an anomaly signal rather than treating it as proof of fraud.

Q9. Where does your training data come from?

Answer:

If you don't yet have a genuinely labelled dataset, **DO NOT BS THIS.**

Say:

Our current SIH prototype uses analytical/demo data and focuses on demonstrating the complete pipeline. For production, we would require properly labelled historical investigation data, validated features and continuous model evaluation. We would not claim production-level accuracy from synthetic or insufficiently labelled data.

Your documentation itself recommends this position.

Q10. How do you calculate the risk score?

Answer:

We combine multiple independent signals: deterministic rule results, ML signals, graph-based risk indicators and evidence confidence. The weights are configurable and would be calibrated using validation data in a production deployment.

Q11. Why not simply use one risk score?

Answer:

Because one score hides the reason behind the decision. We want the investigator to see the contributing factors—for example rapid movement, multiple hops, fund splitting, anomaly detection and graph behavior—so that the score remains explainable.

Q12. Why is a VASP interaction suspicious?

Answer:

VASP interaction by itself is not proof of fraud. It becomes one contextual signal among several others. Our UI distinguishes verified entity matches from inferred or unknown relationships, and we explicitly avoid claiming that the VASP participated in the fraud without supporting evidence.

Excellent answer.

Q13. What happens if the wallet is unknown?

Answer:

We don't force an identity onto it. It remains unknown or unconfirmed. We can still analyze its transaction behavior and relationships without claiming ownership.

Q14. How do you handle thousands of transactions?

Answer:

The MVP uses NetworkX for graph analysis and local processing. For production scale, we move persistent graph storage to Neo4j, relational case data to PostgreSQL, background processing to workers and Redis, and event processing to Kafka or equivalent streaming infrastructure. This allows the analytical workload to scale independently.

Q15. How will you support multiple blockchains?

Answer:

We use blockchain adapters and a common normalized transaction schema. Each blockchain-specific data source is converted into the same internal representation before entering the graph and analytics engine. Therefore adding another chain doesn't require rewriting the entire investigation pipeline.

Your architecture explicitly follows this model.

Q16. Why are you starting with Ethereum?

Answer:

Ethereum provides a mature EVM ecosystem and makes it practical to demonstrate wallet, token-transfer and smart-contract analysis within an SIH prototype. Once the common data model and adapter architecture are established, additional chains can be added incrementally.

Q17. What happens when the attacker uses a crypto mixer?

Answer:

This is a **hard question**.

Don't pretend you can magically solve mixers.

Say:

Mixers significantly increase attribution difficulty because they deliberately break straightforward transaction relationships. Our system would not claim to identify the owner automatically. Instead, it would detect pre-mixer and post-mixer behavior, preserve transaction evidence, identify timing and graph relationships where available, and flag the case for deeper investigation.

That's a much more forensic answer.

Q18. What happens if the attacker uses a bridge?

Answer:

In the production architecture, we model bridge relationships explicitly. A bridge can be treated as a cross-chain transition point, allowing the system to correlate the source-side and destination-side activity where sufficient evidence is available.

Your production architecture specifically includes bridge relationships and cross-chain correlation.

Q19. What happens if there are false positives?

Answer:

That's why our system doesn't treat a risk score as a verdict. We expose the individual risk factors, supporting evidence and uncertainty, and keep a human investigator in the loop. In production, rule weights and ML thresholds would also be calibrated using validated historical cases.

Q20. Why not let AI make the final decision?

Answer:

Because investigation and law enforcement require accountability and evidence. AI can prioritize, summarize and identify patterns, but the final decision should remain with a qualified human investigator. Our architecture is intentionally human-in-the-loop.

Your README explicitly makes this a core philosophy.

Q21. How is this scalable commercially?

Answer:

We see three deployment models: government and law-enforcement licensing, enterprise deployments for exchanges and financial institutions, and SaaS/API-based access for cybersecurity and forensic organizations. The architecture supports scaling from a single-chain SIH prototype to multi-chain, real-time, multi-investigator deployments.

Q22. How will you make money?

Answer:

The primary business model would be B2B and B2G rather than consumer-facing. We could offer annual institutional licenses, investigator-based SaaS pricing, enterprise on-premise deployments and API access. Advanced features such as multi-chain analytics and real-time monitoring could be part of higher tiers.

Q23. Why would the government pay for this if blockchain data is public?

Answer:

This is a **VERY likely judge question.**

Answer:

The value isn't simply accessing blockchain data. The value is reducing the manual investigation effort required to interpret that data. We combine collection, normalization, graph analysis, fund tracing, risk analysis, evidence correlation, investigator recommendations and standardized reporting into one workflow.

This is your business case.

Q24. Why should an investigator trust your system?

Answer:

They shouldn't blindly trust it. That's why our design is evidence-first. Every important finding should be traceable to transactions, data sources, rules or models, and AI interpretations. The investigator can inspect the supporting evidence before accepting a recommendation.

Q25. What is your biggest limitation?

Answer:

Attribution is fundamentally difficult when wallet ownership is unknown, funds pass through privacy-enhancing mechanisms, or evidence is incomplete. Our system therefore focuses on evidence-backed prioritization and investigation support rather than claiming perfect attribution.

This answer actually makes you sound **more mature**, not weaker.

34. Three questions I REALLY expect SIH judges to ask

If you have limited time preparing, memorize these.

“Why can't I just use Etherscan?”

Etherscan shows transactions. We convert those transactions into an investigation workflow: multi-hop tracing, graph analysis, suspicious pattern detection, entity intelligence, ML/rule signals, evidence correlation and standardized reporting.

“How do you prevent AI hallucinations?”

AI only receives structured evidence. Its claims are mapped back to evidence IDs and validated against transaction data. Unsupported claims are marked unsupported or uncertain, and the investigator remains in the loop.

“How will this become a real product?”

The MVP starts with one EVM chain, free data sources, NetworkX and local LLMs. The production architecture replaces these bottlenecks incrementally with PostgreSQL, Neo4j, multi-chain adapters, distributed workers, streaming infrastructure and enterprise deployment while keeping the same investigation pipeline.

35. One concern I want you to fix before SIH

Your **architecture is extremely ambitious**.

That's good for vision.

But a judge can destroy you with:

“You have Qwen + Mistral + Llama + XGBoost + Isolation Forest + NetworkX + Neo4j + Kafka + PostgreSQL + multi-chain + real-time monitoring. Have you actually implemented all of this?”

You **must distinguish three things**:

IMPLEMENTED

What actually works in your prototype.

PROTOTYPED / DEMONSTRATED

What you can demonstrate with controlled/local data.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

What you designed but haven't implemented yet.

Never present the entire production architecture as if you built it.

Your own repository already has a sensible MVP-vs-production distinction.

36. Your 30-second SIH pitch

If a judge says:

“Explain your project in 30 seconds.”

I'd say:

Our solution is an evidence-first cryptocurrency fraud investigation platform. An investigator enters a victim-reported wallet, and the system collects and normalizes its blockchain activity, builds a transaction graph, traces funds across multiple hops, detects suspicious patterns, checks entity or VASP relationships, and combines rule-based and ML risk signals. Three specialized local LLMs then analyze, review and explain the structured evidence. Finally, every important finding is correlated back to its supporting evidence and presented through an investigator dashboard with recommendations and a standardized PDF report. The key idea is that AI assists the investigator—it never replaces evidence or human judgment.

37. Your 1-minute business pitch

The business value is reducing the manual time required for cryptocurrency fraud investigations. Today, investigators may have to manually follow transactions across multiple wallets, identify suspicious patterns, correlate entities and prepare reports. Our platform automates that repetitive analytical work and presents the investigator with prioritized fund paths, explainable risk factors and evidence-backed recommendations. The product can scale from an SIH prototype using free public data and local models to enterprise deployments using PostgreSQL, Neo4j, multi-chain adapters, real-time streaming and secure on-premise infrastructure. Potential customers include cybercrime units, financial institutions, cryptocurrency exchanges, VASPs and blockchain-forensics companies.

38. And your killer closing line

If the judges ask:

“What is the one thing that differentiates you?”

Say:

“We are not trying to make AI decide who is guilty. We are building an evidence-first system that helps an investigator understand where the money went, why a transaction path is suspicious, what evidence supports that conclusion, and what should be investigated next.”

That is **much stronger** than saying:

“We use three LLMs and machine learning.”

Because the technology is not your actual product.

Your actual product is:

Raw blockchain data → investigative intelligence → evidence-backed human decision.